

ZTA Proctor Guide

Reference answers (cheat sheet) + scoring rubric for each use case — aligned to the official Solution Guide. **Do not** show to participants.

How scoring works. Each use case = **100 points** (40 / 30 / 30). Grade each team's submission against the reference answer; award partial credit generously where intent matches. Leaderboard score = sum across submitted use cases. Use Cases 1–3 are required, 4–5 are bonus.

Scoring rubric (applies to every use case)

CRITERION	MAX	WHAT EARNS THE MARKS
Pain-point → product mapping	40	Each customer pain point is mapped to an appropriate Cisco product/feature that genuinely addresses it. Full marks = every pain point covered with the right platform and a clear reason; partial credit per pain point matched.
Products — how & why / differentiators	30	For each product: a correct one-line “how it works” and a convincing “why it fits”. Cisco differentiators earn the top of the band.
Diagram & overall solution	30	Diagram is legible, labels the groups/zones, marks enforcement point(s), traces a flow end-to-end; overall solution is coherent and meets the requirements within budget.

Use Case 1 — Managed Environment — Segmentation

Required

100 pts

Cheat sheet — addressing pain points

CUSTOMER PAIN POINT	EXPECTED CISCO RESPONSE
Prior segmentation failed. Using VLANs/IP subnets is complex and tedious.	Implement SGTs instead of VLAN/IP subnets.
Profiling is labor intensive; staff can't keep up with new devices.	ISE cloud AI profiling.
Failing PCI audits.	Apply SGT for segmentation and insert FW services where L7 security is required.
Corporate PCs not running latest AntiVirus and OS updates.	Use ISE Posture and remediate out-of-date PCs.
No budget for buying more firewalls to do segmentation.	Use SGTs to enforce segmentation within the wired/wireless network.

Cheat sheet — meeting requirements

CUSTOMER REQUIREMENT	EXPECTED CISCO RESPONSE
Employees / IOT / deskagents (Mac-minis) / Guest groups.	Assign an SGT for each group. Authenticate employees via 802.1X or WebAuth; profile Mac-minis (or BYOD/MAB); profile IOT via MAB or manual SGT assignment.
IOT restricted from other groups but needs data center and Internet.	Configure the SGT Matrix to allow IOT → Data Center SGT and Internet only; deny all other destination SGTs.
Guests should have Internet access only.	Configure the SGT Matrix to allow SGT=Guest → SGT=Internet only.
Employee and IOT require controlled internet and data center application access.	Configure the SGT Matrix per source & destination SGTs.
Deskside Mac-Minis access on-prem data center only.	Configure the SGT Matrix: SGT=MacMini permit to SGT=on-prem-DC only.

Cheat sheet — expected products

PRODUCT / FEATURE	HOW IT WORKS	WHY / DIFFERENTIATOR
ISE	Authenticate and profile every user and device (Web, 802.1X, MAB).	Visibility and scalable.

PRODUCT / FEATURE	HOW IT WORKS	WHY / DIFFERENTIATOR
ISE-SGT	Assign an SGT to each group (Employee, IOT, Desktop-Mini, Internet).	Cisco innovation; dynamic policy and topology-independent; end-to-end segmentation into multicloud data centers (on-prem and cloud providers).
ISE SGT ACL policy	Granular access policy.	SGACL more efficient than IP ACLs.
ISE pxGrid	pxGrid / Rapid Threat Containment; shares context with ecosystem devices.	Cisco innovation, RFC8600; dynamically quarantines discovered threat devices; integrates with the Cisco portfolio (ACI, FW, SNA, SD-WAN, CSW, SA, switches, routers).
Catalyst SD-WAN	pxGrid integration for unified security policies via C3 / Security Cloud Control.	Consistent SGT policy across the WAN fabric.
FMC / SCC / FTD	Threat detection/protection via NGIPS, malware protection and content filtering.	Integrates with ISE via pxGrid for Rapid Threat Containment.
FMC / SCC / FTD — source/dest SGT enforcement	Dynamically blocks malicious hosts via SGT matching.	Cisco innovation; dynamic policy enforcement.
Cisco Secure Workload — App Dependency Mapping	Auto-profiles traffic flows and builds application-segmentation policy; ingests NetFlow from FTD.	Auto policy creation, validation and enforcement.
Cisco Secure Workload — pxGrid/ISE integration	pxGrid / ISE connector.	Builds granular segmentation policy based on identity and posture from ISE/pxGrid.

Score sheet

[illegible]

Use Case 2 — Remote Workers — Zero Trust Access

Required

100 pts

Cheat sheet — addressing pain points

CUSTOMER PAIN POINT	EXPECTED CISCO RESPONSE
Full client VPN over-permissive; not Zero Trust.	Use Zero Trust Access from Secure Client to connect to Secure Access.
Manual daily VPN; low satisfaction.	Use the Zero Trust Access module to automatically deliver a per-application VPN tunnel to corporate applications.
Too many sign-ons per application.	Use Duo Passport for SSO.
Want to eliminate password logins / stolen credentials.	Use Duo advanced passwordless.
Existing Okta IdP too expensive.	Use Duo Directory.
CIO wants to modernize branches with SASE.	Integrate SD-WAN into the Secure Access cloud with Direct Internet Access.

Cheat sheet — meeting requirements

CUSTOMER REQUIREMENT	EXPECTED CISCO RESPONSE
Full client VPN for legacy apps; ZTNA for modern apps.	Use the ZT module in Secure Client and create private resources with ZT-module-only access; keep full VPN client access for other legacy corporate apps.
Controlled internet access (block gambling and gaming).	Use Secure Web Gateway (SWG) to block the gambling and gaming categories for corporate employees.
Contractors: clientless RDP access only.	Configure selected private resources to be accessible via browser (TCP) only for contractor groups.
Minimal application sign-ons.	Use Duo Passport or SSO.
Modernize branches with SASE.	Cisco Secure Access integrates with Catalyst SD-WAN to deliver Layer-7 services from the cloud.

Cheat sheet — expected products

PRODUCT / FEATURE	HOW IT WORKS	WHY / DIFFERENTIATOR
Secure Access + Secure Client — ZTA module	The ZT Access module delivers per-app VPN access to private resources.	Ease of use; no full VPN required; meets Zero Trust least-privilege access.
Secure Client VPN module (Full Tunnel)	VPN module provides access to legacy applications.	Mature VPN technology; assigned an SGT for segmentation.

PRODUCT / FEATURE	HOW IT WORKS	WHY / DIFFERENTIATOR
ZTA module (Secure Client)	Intercepts all ports/protocols from the client and redirects to Secure Access for inspection.	Control internet-bound traffic with SWG policy; block gambling and gaming.
Secure Access Private Resources proxy	Proxy for private resources; publishes apps for VPN client, ZTA module, or browser-only (guests, contractors — SSH/RDP).	Easy provisioning of private apps for various user types.
Duo	Duo Passport with SSO.	OS-level SSO login is unique — one login experience.
Secure Access VPNaaS	VPNaaS over on-prem VPN hardware at HQ.	VPN traffic can map to an SGT for segmentation — unique to Cisco.
Secure Access Unified Policy	Unified policy for public and private resources; integrated with SCC/CCC.	Unique to Cisco; ease of use.
Secure Access + SD-WAN	SASE integration with SD-WAN via IPsec tunnels.	Ease of deployment from SD-WAN to Secure Access.

Score sheet

[illegible]

Use Case 3 — AI Access and Agent Controls

Required

100 pts

Cheat sheet — addressing pain points

CUSTOMER PAIN POINT	EXPECTED CISCO RESPONSE
Shadow AI usage is an issue today.	Use Secure Access's built-in AI Access feature to begin controlling corporate AI usage.
Over-privileged / unknown MCP servers in private and public DCs.	Use Secure Access's AI Gateway to register and manage allowed MCP servers.
Users using personal credentials for non-enterprise ChatGPT login.	Use Secure Access's tenant controls for AI.
Downloading of risky AI models.	Secure Access semantic inspection identifies and blocks malicious AI models.

Cheat sheet — meeting requirements

CUSTOMER REQUIREMENT	EXPECTED CISCO RESPONSE
Fine-grained control; users not granted tool rights equally.	Duo / Secure Access MCP integration provides fine-grained AI-tools control along with authentication.
Only the organization's ChatGPT tenant.	Secure Access tenant control enforces the corporate ChatGPT tenant.
Controls for Claude Desktop agents on employee systems.	Duo IdP provides the agent registration process (DCR) to manage and control what registered desktop agents can do.
MCP servers integrated to local agents (Claude Code).	Register and govern MCP servers through the Secure Access AI Gateway with Duo authorization.

Cheat sheet — expected products

PRODUCT / FEATURE	HOW IT WORKS	WHY / DIFFERENTIATOR
AI Access within Secure Access	AI control with guardrails.	Cisco integrates the DLP of Secure Access with Cisco AI Defense — a framework that monitors AI usage, enforces guardrails, and protects data across endpoints, cloud and web.
AI Gateway within Secure Access	AI Gateway controlling registered MCP servers.	Registers/manages allowed MCP servers so agents only reach approved tools.
Secure Access tenant control	Enforces the corporate ChatGPT tenant; blocks personal logins.	Ties AI access to corporate identity.
Secure Access semantic inspection	Identifies and blocks risky/malicious AI models and content.	Purpose-built AI content inspection.

Use Case 4 — Merger & Acquisition — Extend Segmentation

Bonus

100 pts

Cheat sheet — addressing pain points

CUSTOMER PAIN POINT	EXPECTED CISCO RESPONSE
Unsure how to extend segmentation to the acquired company.	Use SGT capability in the remote FTD and enable inline tagging to extend SGT tags from HQ to the remote company.
Not ready to add 100 acquired staff to the corporate directory — quick option?	Use Duo Directory to host the 100 acquired staff; Duo can import users from Okta via SCIM.
Minimize disruptive authentication during transition.	Use Duo SSO routing rules for a seamless experience; apps protected by Okta can still authenticate with Okta until the customer is ready to migrate off Okta.
Acquired company breached; still using passwords.	Use Duo Passwordless.

Cheat sheet — meeting requirements

CUSTOMER REQUIREMENT	EXPECTED CISCO RESPONSE
Extend segmentation to the acquired company using TrustSec.	Use SGT capability in the remote FTD and enable inline tagging to extend SGT tags from HQ to the remote company.
Only selected branch users → restricted resource (Site 9951).	Use source & destination SGTs in the remote FTD access-control policy.

Cheat sheet — expected products

PRODUCT / FEATURE	HOW IT WORKS	WHY / DIFFERENTIATOR
FMC / FTD	FTD builds a site-to-site VPN tunnel from the remote company to the HQ FTD; FTD supports inline SGT per interface.	Cisco SGT inline tagging is a differentiator over others.
Duo — IdP (Directory)	Duo Directory; use SCIM to import users from Okta easily.	Duo ease of use and integration bring overall value.
Duo — IdP (SSO routing)	Duo SSO routing rule maintains a consistent user-auth experience from old Okta to new.	Duo integrates smoothly with other IdPs.
Duo Passwordless	Immediately hardens the breached, password-based acquired users.	Phishing-resistant.
SCC	SCC configures SGT policy into SD-WAN — match source SGT (branch) and destination SGT (acquisition FTD).	SCC provides unified SGT policy management.

Score sheet

[illegible]

Use Case 5 — Zero Trust across Multicloud Data Center

Bonus

100 pts

Note: the source Solution Guide's Use-Case-5 pain-response table repeats Use Case 4's answers by mistake; the mapping below is corrected from the official UC5 requirements-response and product tables.

Cheat sheet — addressing pain points

CUSTOMER PAIN POINT	EXPECTED CISCO RESPONSE
Minimal visibility of applications across multicloud data centers.	Use Cisco Secure Workload App Dependency Mapping to discover apps and flows across on-prem, AWS and Azure.
Lacking segmentation strategy and plan.	Secure Workload auto-baseline policy creation — discover, validate, then enforce microsegmentation.
Wide Kubernetes deployment with latency and visibility issues.	Isovalent (Cilium CNI, eBPF) for Kubernetes observability and protection; Tetragon for runtime protection.
Unable to patch IOT devices.	Segment with Secure Workload / FTD and apply Isovalent/Tetragon runtime protection as compensating controls.
Too many disparate security management interfaces.	Cisco Cloud Control (SCC) unifies multiple UIs into one to simplify policy creation and deployment.

Cheat sheet — meeting requirements

CUSTOMER REQUIREMENT	EXPECTED CISCO RESPONSE
Limited budget; leverage native features; open to virtual appliances.	Use Cisco Secure Workload to discover and manage workloads and apps; CSW integrates with AWS, Azure and others on access-control policies, and can sync policies between CSW and FTDv virtual appliances.
CIO seeking an end-to-end segmentation solution.	ISE common policy shares context via pxGrid to CSW and FTD — ISE becomes an end-to-end segmentation policy engine.
Minimize complexity.	ISE common policy and CSW discovery unify DC firewalling and policy control.

Cheat sheet — expected products

PRODUCT / FEATURE	HOW IT WORKS	WHY / DIFFERENTIATOR
Cisco Secure Workload (CSW)	Agent and agentless design; App Dependency Mapping (discovery); auto-baseline policy creation; granular host policy enforcement; SGT integration with ISE; AWS/Azure platform integration.	CSW provides comprehensive end-to-end policy.
NGFW / FTD	FTD at the edge for agentless networks; flow info from FTD profiles CSW's traffic baseline; CSW pushes auto-policy to FTD.	Cisco's CSW+FTD integration provides the best end-to-end solution.

PRODUCT / FEATURE	HOW IT WORKS	WHY / DIFFERENTIATOR
Isovalent	eBPF for kernel-level protection; Cilium CNI for Kubernetes (observability, security, LB, BGP); Tetragon for runtime protection.	Kernel-level protection via eBPF is a differentiator.
ISE (common policy)	Shares identity/SGT context via pxGrid to CSW and FTD.	One end-to-end segmentation policy engine.
Cisco Cloud Control (SCC)	Unifies multiple management UIs into one.	Simplifies policy creation and deployment; minimizes complexity.

Score sheet

TEAM	MAPPING / 40	PRODUCTS / 30	DIAGRAM / 30	TOTAL / 100